

PROOFS FOR THE EXISTENCE OF GOD AND THEIR CRITIQUE

PROOF ARCHITECTURE → ONTOLOGICAL LINE → COSMOLOGICAL FAMILY → DESIGN AND FINE-TUNING → MORAL ARGUMENT → NYĀYA-UDAYANA PROOF CLUSTER

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure: the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g10 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00 PROOF ARCHITECTURE

PROOF ARCHITECTURE THEISTIC ARGUMENTS START FROM DIFFERENT DATA CONCEPT OF GOD ONTOLOGICAL (A PRIORI) CONTINGENT/MOVED/CAUSED WORLD COSMOLOGICAL (A POSTERIORI) ORDER AND PURPOSIVENESS OBJECTIVE OBLIGATION

THEISTIC ARGUMENTS START FROM DIFFERENT DATA

concept of God → ONTOLOGICAL (a priori)

contingent/moved/caused world → COSMOLOGICAL (a posteriori)

order and purposiveness → TELEOLOGICAL

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- THEISTIC ARGUMENTS START FROM DIFFERENT DATA
- concept of God → ONTOLOGICAL (a priori)
- contingent/moved/caused world → COSMOLOGICAL (a posteriori)

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- order and purposiveness → TELEOLOGICAL
- objective obligation → MORAL
- Indian effect/order/language/karma → NYĀYA-UDAYANA

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- CONTROL: proofs may be deductive, abductive or cumulative
- never judge all by the standard of a single demonstrative syllogism.

MECHANISM / VERDICT → High-value transition: Ontological arguments reason a priori from the God-concept, whereas cosmological, teleological and Nyāya (school of logic and realism) arguments reason a posteriori from experienced reality.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE → WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: High-value transition: Ontological arguments reason a priori from the God-concept, whereas cosmological, teleological and Nyāya (school of logic and realism) arguments reason a posteriori from experienced reality.

01

STAGE 01 ONTOLOGICAL LINE

ONTOLOGICAL LINE THAT THAN WHICH NOTHING GREATER CAN BE CONCEIVED EXISTING NECESSARY EXISTENCE BELONGS TO SUPREMELY PERFECT BEING MODAL FORM POSSIBLY NECESSARY GOD NECESSARILY GOD, IF S5 POSSIBILITY IS GRANTED PERFECT-ISLAND PARODY

EXISTENCE IS NOT A REAL PREDICATE REPLY

DOCTRINE / CLAIM

- ANSELM: God = that than which nothing greater can be conceived existing in reality existing only in understanding
- therefore the greatest conceivable being exists in reality

OBJECTION / PRESSURE

- DESCARTES: necessary existence belongs to supremely perfect being
- MODAL FORM: possibly necessary God → necessarily God, if S5 possibility is granted

REPLY / RESIDUAL

- GAUNIL0: perfect-island parody
- KANT: existence is not a real predicate reply: necessary being is unlike contingent islands; pressure shifts to coherent possibility.

MECHANISM / VERDICT → ANSELM: God = that than which nothing greater can be conceived existing in reality existing only in understanding therefore the greatest conceivable being exists in reality

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE → WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: God = that than which nothing greater can be conceived existing in reality existing only in understanding therefore the greatest conceivable being exists in reality.

02

STAGE 02 COSMOLOGICAL FAMILY

COSMOLOGICAL FAMILY UNMOVED MOVER EFFICIENT CAUSES FIRST CAUSE CONTINGENCY NECESSARY BEING; NOT "EVERY EVENT HAS A CAUSE" WHATEVER BEGINS HAS A CAUSE; UNIVERSE BEGAN; THEREFORE A PRINCIPLE OF SUFFICIENT REASON WHY SOMETHING RATHER THAN NOTHING?

AQUINAS: motion → unmoved mover

efficient causes → first cause contingency → necessary being; not "every event has a cause"

KALĀM: whatever begins has a cause; universe began; therefore a cause

LEIBNIZ: principle of sufficient reason → why something rather than nothing?

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- AQUINAS: motion → unmoved mover
- efficient causes → first cause contingency → necessary being; not "every event has a cause"
- KALĀM: whatever begins has a cause; universe began; therefore a cause

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- LEIBNIZ: principle of sufficient reason → why something rather than nothing?
- HUME: causal principle may not extend beyond experience; universe may be brute
- RUSSELL: universe is "just there"; composition fallacy

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- REPLY: argument concerns contingent totality's explanation, not a member-cause in time.

MECHANISM / VERDICT → KALĀM: whatever begins has a cause; universe began; therefore a cause

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE → WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: whatever begins has a cause; universe began; therefore a cause.

03

STAGE 03 DESIGN AND FINE-TUNING

DESIGN AND FINE-TUNING COMPLEX PURPOSIVE ADAPTATION WATCHMAKER ANALOGY LIFE-PERMITTING CONSTANTS APPEAR WITHIN NARROW RANGE RIVAL EXPLANATIONS PHYSICAL NECESSITY MULTIVERSE + SELECTION EFFECT UNKNOWN DEEPER LAW

WEAK ANALOGY, MANY DESIGNERS, IMPERFECT DESIGNER

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EVALUATION / TRAP
PALEY: complex purposive adaptation → watchmaker analogy → designer	chance / multiverse + selection effect	DARWIN: adaptation by selection verdict: modern design is probabilistic/abductive, not Paley's biological inference unchanged.
FINE-TUNING: life-permitting constants appear within narrow range rival explanations	unknown deeper law	
physical necessity	HUME: weak analogy, many designers, imperfect designer	
SYSTEM / DOCTRINE • PALEY: complex purposive adaptation → watchmaker analogy → designer • FINE-TUNING: life-permitting constants appear within narrow range rival explanations • physical necessity	DECISIVE DISTINCTION • chance / multiverse + selection effect • unknown deeper law • HUME: weak analogy, many designers, imperfect designer	EVALUATION / TRAP • DARWIN: adaptation by selection verdict: modern design is probabilistic/abductive, not Paley's biological inference unchanged.

MECHANISM / VERDICT → HUME: weak analogy, many designers, imperfect designer | DARWIN: adaptation by selection verdict: modern design is probabilistic/abductive, not Paley's biological inference unchanged.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE → WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: weak analogy, many designers, imperfect designer | DARWIN: adaptation by selection verdict: modern design is probabilistic/abductive, not Paley's biological inference unchanged.

04

STAGE 04 MORAL ARGUMENT

MORAL ARGUMENT MORALITY DOES NOT THEORETICALLY PROVE GOD HIGHEST GOOD (VIRTUE) PRACTICAL POSTULATES FREEDOM + IMMORTALITY + GOD CONTEMPORARY ROUTE OBJECTIVE MORAL OBLIGATIONS ADEQUATE PERSONAL GROUND OBJECTION

EUTHYPHRO DILEMMA; SECULAR REALISM CAN GROUND MORAL FACTS REPLY MODIFIED DIVINE COMMAND GROUNDS OBLIGATION IN COMMANDS FLOWING FROM

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- KANT: morality does not theoretically prove God highest good (virtue proportioned to happiness) → practical postulates
- freedom + immortality + God contemporary route: objective moral obligations → adequate personal ground objection: Euthyphro dilemma

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- secular realism can ground moral facts reply: modified divine command grounds obligation in commands flowing from good nature
- KANT: morality does not theoretically prove God highest good (virtue proportioned to happiness) → practical postulates

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- freedom + immortality + God contemporary route: objective moral obligations → adequate personal ground objection: Euthyphro dilemma
- secular realism can ground moral facts reply: modified divine command grounds obligation in commands flowing from good nature

MECHANISM / VERDICT → Core argument: Kant's structure: moral law obligates → its complete object is the highest good (virtue + proportionate happiness) → ought implies can → holiness unattainable in finite time (immortality) and nature does not proportion happiness to virtue (God) → plus freedom, presupposed by obligation.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE → WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Core argument: Kant's structure: moral law obligates → its complete object is the highest good (virtue + proportionate happiness) → ought implies can → holiness unattainable in finite time (immortality) and nature does not proportion happiness to virtue (God) → plus freedom, presupposed by obligation.

05

STAGE 05 NYĀYA-UDAYANA PROOF CLUSTER

NYĀYA-UDAYANA PROOF CLUSTER UDAYANA'S ROUTES TO ĪŚVARA KĀRYĀT WORLD AS EFFECT MAKER ĀYOJANĀT ATOMIC COMBINATION ARRANGER DHṚTYĀDEH SUPPORT/DISSOLUTION PADĀT CONVENTIONAL WORD-USE PRATYAYATAH

UDAYANA'S ROUTES TO ĪŚVARA kāryāt: world as effect → maker āyojanāt: atomic combination → arranger

conventional word-use pratyayatāh: trustworthy cognition śruteh/vākyaṭ: Vedic discourse samkhyāvivēṣaṭ: determinate magnitudes adṛṣṭaṭ: karmic allocation

ĪŚVARA = omniscient efficient cause

eternal atoms = material causes not creation ex nihilo

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- UDAYANA'S ROUTES TO ĪŚVARA kāryāt: world as effect → maker āyojanāt: atomic combination → arranger dhṛtyādeh: support/dissolution padāt
- conventional word-use pratyayatāh: trustworthy cognition śruteh/vākyaṭ: Vedic discourse samkhyāvivēṣaṭ: determinate magnitudes adṛṣṭaṭ: karmic allocation

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- ĪŚVARA = omniscient efficient cause
- eternal atoms = material causes not creation ex nihilo

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- proof aims at intelligent coordination of a realist cosmos.
- UDAYANA'S ROUTES TO ĪŚVARA kāryāt: world as effect → maker āyojanāt: atomic combination → arranger dhṛtyādeh: support/dissolution padāt

MECHANISM / VERDICT → Recommended opening definition: Nyāya (school of logic and realism) infers an omniscient efficient cause that orders eternal atoms and dispenses karmic fruits, not a material creator from nothing.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE → WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Recommended opening definition: Nyāya (school of logic and realism) infers an omniscient efficient cause that orders eternal atoms and dispenses karmic fruits, not a material creator from nothing.

06

STAGE 06 INDIAN AND WESTERN CRITIQUES

INDIAN AND WESTERN CRITIQUES NO PERCEPTION OF GOD; INFERENCE OVERREACHES MOMENTARY DEPENDENT SERIES NEEDS NO PERMANENT CREATOR BEGINNINGLESS JĪVA/ĀJĪVA AND KARMA; CREATION MAKES GOD RESPONSIBLE FOR

VEDA IS AUTHORLESS; DHARMA/APŪRVA EXPLAINS RITUAL FRUIT WITHOUT DIVINE CAUSAL/DESIGN INFERENCE EXCEEDS CATEGORIES OR EXPERIENCE NYĀYA REPLY UNCONSCIOUS ATOMS, APŪRVA OR KARMA CANNOT INTELLIGENTLY ALLOCATE ORDER

DOCTRINE / CLAIM	OBJECTION / PRESSURE	REPLY / RESIDUAL
CĀRVĀKA: no perception of God; inference overreaches	MIMĀṂSĀ: Veda is authorless; dharma/apūrva explains ritual fruit without divine author	COUNTER: coordination may show explanatory gap, not uniquely the Nyāya God.
BUDDHIST: momentary dependent series needs no permanent creator	HUME/KANT: causal/design inference exceeds categories or experience	
JAINA: beginningless jīva/ājīva and karma; creation makes God responsible for evil	NYĀYA REPLY: unconscious atoms, apūrva or karma cannot intelligently allocate order	
DOCTRINE / CLAIM • CĀRVĀKA: no perception of God; inference overreaches • BUDDHIST: momentary dependent series needs no permanent creator • JAINA: beginningless jīva/ājīva and karma; creation makes God responsible for evil	OBJECTION / PRESSURE • MIMĀṂSĀ: Veda is authorless; dharma/apūrva explains ritual fruit without divine author • HUME/KANT: causal/design inference exceeds categories or experience • NYĀYA REPLY: unconscious atoms, apūrva or karma cannot intelligently allocate order	REPLY / RESIDUAL • COUNTER: coordination may show explanatory gap, not uniquely the Nyāya God.

MECHANISM / VERDICT → Recommended opening definition: Mīmāṃsā (school of inquiry into ritual duty) treats the Veda (sacred revealed knowledge) as authorless and karma (morally consequential action) as self-fructifying, thereby displacing the need for God.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE → WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Recommended opening definition: Mīmāṃsā (school of inquiry into ritual duty) treats the Veda (sacred revealed knowledge) as authorless and karma (morally consequential action) as self-fructifying, thereby displacing the need for God.

07

STAGE 07 CUMULATIVE VERDICT AND ANSWER PLAN

CUMULATIVE VERDICT AND ANSWER PLAN DEFINE TARGET GOD CLASSIFY ARGUMENT FORMALISE PREMISES EXPOSE HIDDEN BRIDGE STRONGEST NAMED CRITIC BEST REPLY TEST WHAT CONCLUSION ACTUALLY ESTABLISHES ONTOLOGICAL

DEFINE target God → classify argument → formalise premises → expose hidden bridge

strongest named critic → best reply → test what conclusion actually establishes ontological: necessity if

cosmological: ground if PSR design: probability, not deduction

moral: practical/normative support

Nyāya: intelligent order within atomism

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

- DEFINE target God → classify argument → formalise premises → expose hidden bridge
- strongest named critic → best reply → test what conclusion actually establishes ontological: necessity if possibility
- cosmological: ground if PSR design: probability, not deduction

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- moral: practical/normative support
- Nyāya: intelligent order within atomism
- QUALIFIED VERDICT: no proof compels every rational agent

EVALUATION / TRAP

- together they can form a cumulative case only if their contested modal, causal, probabilistic and moral premises stand.

MECHANISM / VERDICT → QUALIFIED VERDICT: no proof compels every rational agent; together they can form a cumulative case only if their contested modal, causal, probabilistic and moral premises stand.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE → WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: no proof compels every rational agent; together they can form a cumulative case only if their contested modal, causal, probabilistic and moral premises stand.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT → ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT ADVANCED CARDS MOVED FROM THE COMPLETE LEARNER SOURCE → CANONICAL ADVANCED DOCTRINE DOSSIERS → [OPTIONAL ADVANCED] PHILOSOPHY OF RELIGION DOSSIER TOPIC 2 → [OPTIONAL ADVANCED] DOCTRINE STATEMENT.

ANSELM ARGUES A PRIORI FROM THE CONCEPT OF GOD (1) EVEN THE DENIER UNDERSTANDS THE CONCEPT

OPTIONAL SOURCE WITNESS

- Advanced cards moved from the complete learner source → [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]
- Canonical advanced doctrine dossiers → [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]
- Philosophy of Religion dossier: Topic 2 → [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]
- Doctrine statement.

ADVANCED OBJECTION

- Anselm argues a priori from the concept of God as that than which no greater can be conceived to existence not merely in understanding but in reality.
- Argument.
- (1) Even the denier understands the concept
- (2) existing in reality is greater than existing only in understanding

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

- (3) if God existed only in understanding, a greater could be conceived
- (4) contradiction
- therefore God exists.
- Descartes recasts existence as inseparable from supremely perfect being.

OPTIONAL STATUS → This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.